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21LEM202T — Unit 1, Session 7, SLO 1

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity 1 — Aspirations, Achievements and Concerns

List a few of your own in each column.

Aspirations	Achievements	Concerns
To be financially independent	**Completed my first internship**	**Balancing studies and family responsibilities**
To be healthy and fit	**Ran a 5K race**	**Managing time for exercise**
To build meaningful relationships	**Made a close friend in college**	**Fear of losing touch after graduation**

Activity 2 — Why Am I Making This Effort?

Trace one of your efforts through the four steps.

Which of these is your basic aspiration (1, 2, 3 or 4)? Are the rest just steps toward it?

The basic aspiration is **4 (Be something: happy and prosperous)**. The rest (1, 2, 3) are just steps toward it.

Present effort	→ Become something	→ Get / do something	→ Be something?
Studying for exams	**Become a knowledgeable engineer**	**Get a good job**	**Be happy and prosperous**
Exercising daily	**Become fit and energetic**	**Get a healthy body**	**Be content and peaceful**

Activity 3 — How Are You Planning Your Life?

Tick one and explain in a line:

- 1-2-3-4: plan the steps without being clear of the basic aspiration, OR
- 4-3-2-1: get clarity of the basic aspiration first, then work out the steps.

4-3-2-1: I first clarify that my basic aspiration is to be happy and prosperous, then I decide what to become, do, and get to achieve that.

Activity 4 — When the Favourite Path is Closed

Recall a situation where your “favourite” path was closed (branch, college, roommate…). What did you feel, think and do? What would be the appropriate response?

When I didn't get into my first-choice college, I felt disappointed and anxious. I thought my future was ruined. I spent days worrying instead of looking for alternatives. The appropriate response would be to accept the situation, recognise that my basic aspiration (to be happy and prosperous) does not depend on that one college, and find an alternate path that still leads to the same goal.

Home Assignment — What Is Required to Fulfil Each?

For each aspiration or concern, mark what is required: right understanding, fulfilment in relationship, and/or physical facility.

Aspiration or Concern	Right understanding	Fulfilment in relationship	Physical facility
Good health	**Yes**	**No**	**Yes**
Lasting friendships	**Yes**	**Yes**	**No**

Aspiration or Concern	Right understanding	Fulfilment in relationship	Physical facility
Financial security	Yes	No	Yes
Harmonious family life	Yes	Yes	Yes

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

Q1. Using the sequence "present effort → become something → get/do something → be something," explain how our various efforts are only steps toward one basic aspiration. What is that basic aspiration?

All our efforts follow the sequence: we make a present effort to become something (e.g., a doctor), then to get or do something (e.g., earn money, treat patients), and finally to be something (e.g., be happy, be fulfilled). This reveals that every effort ultimately aims at the one basic aspiration: to be happy and fulfilled (or to be in a state of continuous happiness and prosperity).

Q2. Compare life with clarity of basic aspiration and life without clarity of basic aspiration.

Life with clarity of basic aspiration: one knows that the ultimate goal is happiness and fulfilment, so efforts are aligned with right understanding, relationships, and physical needs; decisions are coherent and lead to lasting satisfaction. Life without clarity: one chases temporary goals (wealth, status, sensory pleasures) mistaking them for the ultimate goal, leading to confusion, conflict, and a sense of emptiness even after achieving them.

Q3. When a "favourite path" to what we assume to be our goal is closed, what is the appropriate response, and why?

The appropriate response is to re-examine the goal itself, not to cling to the closed path. Because the favourite path is only a means, not the end; if the end (basic aspiration of happiness) is clear, one can choose an alternative path that also leads to that end. Clinging to a closed path causes frustration, while adapting the means keeps one aligned with the true goal.